



Hold My Spot vs. the Incumbents

Why a live, learning queue wins the public-sector market

The market as it stands

Queue management for government is a decade-old category that has stopped innovating. The entrenched players sell one of two things: expensive on-premise hardware stacks, or a digital ticket with SMS notifications bolted on. None predict a real wait time with a learning model, none get a person document-ready before they arrive, and none treat adherence as a measured outcome. The category is ready to be displaced, and the incumbents' own architecture is now generating lawsuits.

The players

Qmatic is the top-ranked legacy incumbent, deeply embedded in large state and county deployments. Its strength is also its ceiling: an on-premise, hardware-heavy stack of kiosks, ticket dispensers, and signage. Powerful, expensive, slow to deploy, and its business model depends on selling the very hardware a modern buyer wants to eliminate.

QLess is the brand name in government and higher education, live in more than 300 cities and counties, and actively rolling out to DMVs. It blends appointments and walk-ins with configurable priority. But it has documented weaknesses: opaque pricing, reported stability and support concerns, and no predictive routing or document readiness. It is a scheduling and notification system, not an intelligence layer.

WaitWell is the modern SaaS challenger winning government evaluations against QLess on flexibility and support, and it replaced the prior system at a statewide DMV. It proves the incumbent is displaceable, the most important fact in this market. It is still a queue and scheduling tool without an agentic readiness layer or a learning wait-time model.

Waitwhile, Qnomy, Nemo-Q round out the field as lighter commercial tools or older enterprise hardware systems. None change the core picture.

The gap none of them fill

Every incumbent gets a person into a line and sends them a text. Not one solves the two things that actually define the public-service experience: whether the wait estimate is real, and whether the person is ready to be served when they reach the counter. That gap is the whole opportunity.

Moat one: architecture that cannot be scalped

The incumbent model sells a scarce, fixed appointment slot booked in advance. That model created a black market. In Florida, bots and fake accounts hoarded free DMV appointments and resold them for 25 to 250 dollars, the state was canceling roughly a thousand fictitious appointments a day, and it produced a class action alleging citizens were forced to camp overnight. Counties have since passed ordinances criminalizing appointment resale.

Hold My Spot is structurally immune. There is no scarce, transferable slot to hoard. A place in a live queue is a position you must be real and present to hold, confirmed at the right moment and released on a grace window if you are not. You cannot resell a spot that requires you to actually show up to keep it. This is a moat the incumbents cannot cross without abandoning the model their whole product is built on.

Moat two: readiness, so nobody waits to be turned away

The single most enraging public-service experience is waiting an hour to be sent home for the wrong document. The entire category ignores it. Hold My Spot's agentic readiness layer identifies the transaction type at join, confirms the exact documents needed in plain language, and does not call the person forward until their checklist is complete. It attacks the most wasteful event in the building, the failed visit, which costs the citizen their time and the office a slot that gets re-consumed on the return trip. It is also the capability that makes the intelligence real rather than decorative, running on a governed agentic engine that keeps a human in control of anything affecting a person's place in line.

Side by side

Capability	Qmatic	QLess	WaitWell	Hold My Spot
Unified appointment and walk-in queue	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Real-time predictive wait, learning model	No	No	No	Yes
Document readiness before arrival	No	No	No	Yes
Agentic routing by transaction and arrival	No	No	No	Yes
Adherence as a measured, reported outcome	Partial	No	Partial	Yes
Resistant to appointment scalping	No	No	No	Yes
No back-office hardware required	No	Partial	Yes	Yes
Fast, single-site pilot deployment	No	Partial	Yes	Yes

Where we are honest about the gap

The incumbents have what a young challenger does not: existing state contract vehicles, years of references, completed security and accessibility audits, and teams who navigate long procurements. We do not out-procurement them. We out-innovate them at one office, produce two hard numbers, wait-time reduction and failed-visit reduction, and use that reference to enter procurement conversations we would otherwise lose on paper. WaitWell already proved the incumbent is beatable. We beat them on the two things they structurally cannot match.

The existing systems sell scheduled appointments, which is exactly what created the scalping black market and the lawsuits. **Hold My Spot runs a live, learning queue that cannot be hoarded, and gets people document-ready before they arrive so they are not turned away at the window.** No appointment scarcity to game, no failed visits, no hardware stack to buy.

Hold My Spot is built on the governed agentic engine developed by Trogon United. A working prototype of the queue engine exists today.